

SCOPE

AMEX Healthcare GmbH
Wholesale of pharmaceuticals and other medical products

AMEX Healthcare Kenya SEZ Limited
Wholesale of pharmaceuticals and other medical products

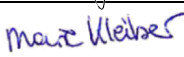
RELATED DOCUMENTS

WI 11 – Trending Analysis for DCR
WI 16 – Handling of Recalls in AMEX Healthcare Kenya SEZ Limited

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment 1 – DCR Tracker and CAPA Overview (v4)
Attachment 2 – CAPA Report (v4)

SIGNATURE BLOCK

	NAME	FUNCTION	SIGNATURE	DATE
CREATED	Nikolina Ilic	Senior Quality Specialist		18.05.2026
CREATED	Ivana Zivkovic	Quality Specialist		18.05.2026
REVIEWED	Milica Bisercic	Quality Manager / Responsible Pharmacist		18.05.2026
REVIEWED	Dorothy Amony	Quality Manager Kenya / Responsible Pharmacist		18.05.2026
APPROVED	Marie Kleiber	CEO / Responsible Person		18.05.2026

1 PURPOSE

This SOP describes the handling of deviations, complaints, safety notices and recalls, as well as issues Amex had with partner companies. SOP 5 in conjunction with Working Instructions (WI) 11 outlines the procedure for performing quarterly and annual trending analysis of DCR entries. It ensures that they are documented and processed in a structured way.

DCR analysis further supports risk management as it serves as a foundation for identifying risk patterns and developing targeted strategies to mitigate identified risks.

2 GOAL

The aim of this process is to handle all DCR entries effectively and efficiently. Any consequences and their causes need to be limited or eliminated by appropriate measures.

Especially for pharmaceuticals, it is necessary to ensure that products affected by a batch or product recall are immediately and completely removed from the circulation and the supply chain.

3 RESPONSIBILITIES

Function / Department	Activity
All employees = Focal Point (FP)	- Recording of deviations, complaints, safety notices and recalls, partner issue reports - Informing QD and CEO depending on severity - Implementation of immediate actions, if necessary - Handling of CAPA
Quality department (QD) / Responsible Pharmacist (RP)	- Recording of deviations, complaints, safety notices and recalls, partner issue reports - Implementation of immediate actions, if necessary - In case of critical DCRs: processing and evaluation of complaints and non-compliance issues in cooperation with FP - Ensuring relevant actions are performed as stated in the CAPA plan - Coordination and processing of recalls and safety notices - Perform mock recall if applicable - Performs quarterly/annual analysis of DCR entries
Responsible Person	- Reviews and signs off raised CAPA concerning pharmaceuticals - Reviews and signs off quarterly/annual DCR analysis performed by the Quality Department

4 DESCRIPTION OF ACTIVITIES

The following process (Figure 1) needs to be followed by the focal point:

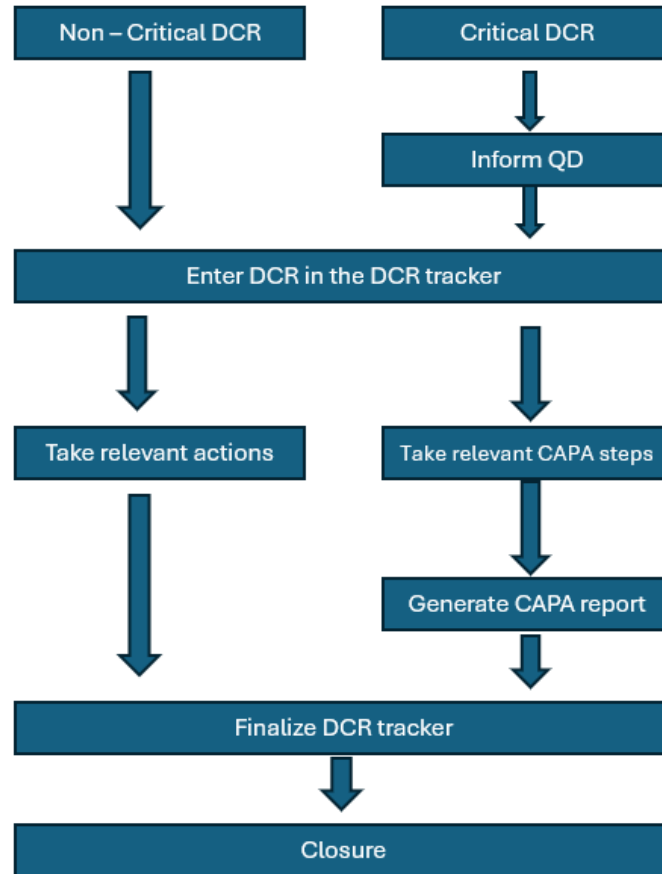


Figure 1: Flow chart for DCR process

4.1 Description and definition of deviations, complaints and recalls

	Definition	Example
Deviation	A <i>deviation</i> is defined as non-compliance with a specified procedure, standard, GDP requirement, or any relevant agreement. This could involve a failure to adhere to established procedures, processes, or contractual obligations. The irregularity is noticed before it arrives at the customer's location. A CAPA process is initiated to correct the issue and ensure the customer receives a flawless service. In some cases, the customer needs to be informed nevertheless.	- An item arrives broken at the AMEX warehouse. - Pharmaceutical products are transported without temperature monitoring device. - Products are received with missing or incorrect labels. - A medication shipment is stored/transported outside the required temperature range.
Complaint	A complaint is an irregularity that is reported	- An item arrives broken at the customer's

Recall	by the customer. The irregularity can be justified or not – this needs to be investigated by the FP. A CAPA process might need to be initiated to correct the issue and ensure the customer is satisfied. This might involve providing information only or even re-shipment of goods.	site and customer files a complaint - A customer reports an expired item - A customer reports receipt of a wrong item - A customer reports irregularities in the data logger report of a cold chain shipment - A customer complains about an installation partner
	A recall is a request to return a product from the market. It is generally done after the discovery of a safety issue or product defect that might endanger the consumer.	- A product is found to be poorly manufactured - A product is mislabelled or poorly packaged - A product is potentially contaminated - A product that is supposed to be sterile, is found not to be sterile
	Safety notice is a formal document received from manufacturer informing users of potential risks or required actions on the item level. Must be actioned as required by the manufacturer. QD will be responsible to coordinate safety notice distribution to impacted customers/end users. QD might request FP to support.	- New calibration values - Required software updates
	Partner issue report represent any issue Amex employees faced in collaboration with suppliers, warehouses, freight forwarders This will support DCR analysis and allow better partner oversight. The employee is required to enter the details of the identified issue in the DCR tracker no later than one week after the closure date.	- Failure to provide requested information/documentation in a timely manner - Repeated mistakes in invoicing, e.g., charging for the service Amex did not request - Missed deadlines due to internal issues on the Partner's end

Table 1: Definitions of deviations, complaints, recalls, safety notices, partner issue reports and examples

4.1.1 Deviation

For definition of Deviation, please refer to the Table 1.

Any Amex employee may identify a deviation. Upon awareness, the deviation must be logged in the DCR tracker as soon as possible, but no later than 3 calendar days from the date of awareness. If all information is not immediately available, the employee is required to enter the details currently available in the DCR tracker and update it with any missing information no later than one week after the closure date.

Further, deviation could be defined as critical or non-critical. Please refer to section 4.1.4 for further instructions. Quality department should be informed in case the deviation is classified as critical.

Customers should be informed of the CAPA if directly impacted.

4.1.2 Complaint

For definition of Complaint, please refer to Table 1.

Any Amex employee may receive a complaint. Upon awareness, the complaint must be logged in the DCR tracker as soon as possible, but no later than 3 calendar days from the date of awareness. If all information is not immediately available, the employee is required to enter the details currently available in the DCR tracker and update it with any missing information no later than one week after the closure date.

Further, complaints could be defined as critical or non-critical. Please refer to section 4.1.4 for further instructions.

Quality department should be informed in case the complaint is classified as critical.

Any complaint concerning pharmaceutical products/critical medical items, or specific batch of products supplied, is to be thoroughly investigated and is to include a root cause analysis, QC retesting if needed, risk assessment and effective CAPA to avoid recurrence. The nature of the complaint is to be communicated to the manufacturer or supplier. The outcome of the investigation must be communicated to the complainant.

4.1.3 Recall and Field safety notice and Alerts

A **Field Safety Notice** is a communication issued by manufacturers or distributors of medical devices, pharmaceuticals, or laboratory equipment to inform users about a specific safety issue related to a product that is already on the market. This notice typically includes:

1. **Identification of the Product:** Clear details about the affected product, such as the name, model, and batch or serial numbers.
2. **Description of the Safety Issue:** An explanation of the identified risk or problem, including how it might affect safety or performance.
3. **User Actions Required:** Instructions or recommendations for users, which may include monitoring for specific issues, suspending use, returning the product, or implementing corrective actions.
4. **Contact Information:** Details for users to obtain further information or support. The primary purpose of a Field Safety Notice is to mitigate any potential risks to patients or users by providing timely and accurate information, ensuring ongoing safety and effectiveness of the product in the field. These notices are part of a comprehensive post-market surveillance system and are crucial for maintaining regulatory compliance and upholding public health standards.

An **Alert** is communication regarding a potential product quality issue and/or GMP non-compliance for the site, issued by a Regulatory Authority, identified by the customer or in any other way communicated to AMEX. The alert itself does not represent a complaint or recall, nor can it be treated by default like that. The alert is to be communicated to the QD/RP who is in charge of further investigation. The product that is potentially impacted would be put in a quarantine immediately, until final decision on its release or destruction is made.

The QD should confirm receipt of the safety notice within one working day. Additionally, QD must ensure that all relevant stakeholders are identified and informed about the safety notice as per timelines shared by the manufacturer. Once all actions required per safety notice are performed, QD must inform the manufacturer or supplier of the same and share signed safety notice, if required.

Recall is a process initiated by a manufacturer, distributor, or regulatory authority to remove a product from the market or correct a problem with a product that is not in compliance with safety, efficacy, or quality standards. Recalls are typically issued for products that may pose a health hazard or violate regulatory guidelines.

Reasons for product recalls might be for example:

- A product is found to be poorly manufactured
- A product is mislabeled or poorly packaged
- A product is potentially contaminated
- A product that is supposed to be sterile, is found not to be sterile

The QD must issue all appropriate information and directives to the contracted logistics partner to ensure that the recall is timely and properly handled and coordinated. In case of batches or product recalls, all the batches or the entire article stock must be appropriately marked and quarantined by the contracted logistics partner to prevent further distribution of the product. In case of transport of recalled products, goods are to be kept separated, secured and clearly labelled as such, to avoid any risk of mixing with regular products.

The QD must ensure that all relevant stakeholders (customers, manufacturers, NDRA etc.) are informed about the recalls as soon as possible, not later than 24 hours.

For AMEX Kenya, the Guidelines for Recall and Withdrawal of Medical Products and Health Technologies

(HPT/PDS/VMS/GUD/030) shall apply. For more details regarding handling of recalls by Amex Healthcare Kenya SEZ Limited, refer to WI 16 – Handling of Recalls in AMEX Healthcare Kenya SEZ Limited.

Handling recalls includes, but it is not limited to sending official emails as well as follow-up calls to make sure the information has been received, understood and all measures are taken accordingly.

Contacts of all relevant stakeholders are to be easily accessible in AMEX ERP system or other databases (emails, archive system, documents etc.).

The following information is to be communicated where applicable:

- Reason for recall
- Product name / model number
- Batch number
- Expiry Date
- Quantity shipped to the customer
- Shipping Date
- Invoice Number and Delivery Note Number
- Further instructions – retrieval and quarantine

In general, every recall is to be treated as critical and handled with full priority from all AMEX employees, and the QD shall then apply respective regulatory requirements.

The recalled items must be collected, quarantined and returned to the supplier or destroyed. Decision is made in consultation with the supplier. These goods may no longer be included in the supply chain.

Full batch traceability is ensured always using both AMEX and contracted logistics partner's relevant SOPs and ERP systems.

All relevant details of the recall and of corrective and preventive action (CAPA) and outcome must be recorded. The reconciliation procedure is to be initiated after obtaining relevant data and reports from all stakeholders (customers and warehouses). Results are to be documented as part of the report.

Contact person(s) for recalls at AMEX:

Milica Bisercic
Quality Manager, Responsible Pharmacist
milica.bisercic@amex-healthcare.com
+43 1 876 76 00 – 219

Dorothy Amony
Quality Manager, Responsible Pharmacist
dorothy.amony.@amex-healthcare.com
+43 1 876 76 00 – 274

Marie Kleiber
CEO, Responsible Person
marie.kleiber@amex-healthcare.com
+43 680 55 32 567

Whenever a recall occurs, Federal Office for Safety in Health Care should be informed by sending description of the recall to the following email address am-qualitaetsmangel@basg.gv.at. That would be the responsibility of a Quality Specialist/Responsible Pharmacist.

4.1.4 Critical DCRs versus non-critical DCRs

At AMEX, all DCRs are classified as critical or non-critical (Table 3).

Classification	Definition	Examples	Actions to be taken by Focal Point	Actions to be taken by Quality Department	Actions to be taken by Responsible Person
Critical	Any DCR fulfilling one or more of the following criteria: - Proven or potential impact on product safety and/or quality - Financial impact on AMEX > EUR 10.000, - - DCR identified as systematic issue during the review of the DCR tracker	- Temperature deviations during temperature-controlled shipments, in case proven impact on product safety and/or quality. E.g., when the manufacturer does not confirm release of the product and/or internal risk assessment concludes the product is unfit for further handling. - Item with a value of > 10.000 EUR are found to be broken after transport - Customer reports deviation between CoA and information on actual product - Packaging of sterile products is found to be damaged - In any other way found critical for patient safety.	Focal Point is responsible to: - Inform QD - Enter DCR to DCR tracker - Generate CAPA report	Quality Department is responsible to: Ensure that all critical DCRs are investigated, documented and followed by an appropriate CAPA plan	Responsible Person is responsible to: - Reviews and signs off raised CAPA, concerning pharmaceuticals - Reviews and signs off quarterly/annual DCR analysis performed by the Quality Department <i>* Responsible Person must be involved only in all DCR concerning pharmaceuticals</i>
	In case of uncertainty if a DCR is critical, the FP needs to consult with the QD.	Critical product categories include (but are not limited to): - Pharmaceuticals - Sterile products e.g. consumables used for IV therapy like syringes, needles, catheters, sutures etc. - Blood transfusion and preservation consumables e.g. blood bag systems etc. - Personal protective equipment for high-risk exposure e.g. biohazard suits, level 4 surgical gowns etc. - Lifesaving equipment e.g. anaesthesia machines, patient monitors etc. - In Vitro Diagnostic products - Cold chain products - Surgical instruments			

Classification	Definition	Examples	Actions to be taken by Focal Point	Actions to be taken by Quality Department	Actions to be taken by Responsible Person
Non-Critical	All other DCRs	- A box of glass vials is broken during transport - The warehouse forgets to add one specific carton to a shipment - Outside packaging is slightly damaged, inside packaging is found to be intact	Focal Point is responsible to: Enter DCR to DCR tracker	Quality Department is responsible to: - Support FP in case of a need - Ensure that all information has been added to the DCR tracker	Responsible Person is responsible to: Reviews and signs off quarterly/annual DCR analysis performed by the Quality Department <i>* Responsible Person must be involved only in all DCR concerning pharmaceuticals</i>

Table 3. Definition of Critical and Non-Critical DCRs

** Note: All temperature deviations must undergo a documentation assessment to evaluate potential impact on product quality, including review of data logger report and stability data, where applicable.*

4.2 DCR Tracker and CAPA Overview

All deviations, complaints, safety notices and recalls, as well as issues with partner companies must be recorded in Attachment 1 DCR Tracker and CAPA Overview. The responsible FP should record the issue in the DCR Tracker. In case it is needed, involvement of QD might be asked.

TIMELINE FOR COMPLETING DCR TRACKER	
Basic recording in DCR Tracker	Recording of all details in DCR Tracker
Immediately	1 week after closure of case

TIMELINE FOR CLOSING DCR CASES	
Critical DCR	Non-Critical DCRs
Immediately addressed, closed within 30 calendar days*	60 calendar days*

*Note: In exceptional cases where investigations require additional time, a written justification and revised closure timeline must be approved by the Quality Department (QD).

The DCR Tracker must undergo an annual trending analysis conducted by the QD to identify any patterns and emerging trends. The findings and insights from the analysis must be captured in the Management Review and shared on company level (e.g. during AHM), and necessary corrective measures must be discussed, communicated, and documented to ensure continuous improvement and regulatory compliance. Further details regarding trending analysis can be found in Section 5.

The following columns need to be filled in the DCR Tracker (Table 4):

Valid from		SIGNUM		PAGE 8 / 12
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In case this document is printed, it may not correspond to latest valid version.

The only official and valid version is available as hard copy in the QMS folder with the Quality Team.

Column	Explanation	Responsible for filling into DCR tracker	
		Non-Critical DCR	Critical DCR
DCR Tracking Number	A unique identifier for each case in the tracker. This should be a combination of year and sequential number for easy tracking.: YY- ### YY Year (23, 24 etc.) ### Consecutive Numbering For example: 24-052 (52nd DCR in year 2024)	Focal Point	Focal Point
Type D/C/R/S/PIR	Categorize the issue into Deviation, Complaint, Recall, Safety notice, Partner issue report. Choose the appropriate category from a drop-down menu: • D = Deviation • C = Complaint • R = Recall • S = Safety notice • PIR = Partner Issue Report	Focal Point	Focal Point
Critical DCR (Y/N)	Assess if the DCR is critical or not; if critical enter Y, if not critical enter N	Focal Point	Focal Point QD
Amex entity impacted	Choose if Amex Vienna or Amex Kenya is impacted by this DCR	Focal Point	Focal Point
DCR occurred on (date)	The date when the issue first occurred. If unknown, use the date when an Amex employee becomes aware of it. Enter the date in a consistent format (DD-MM-YYYY).	Focal Point	Focal Point
Entered by	This field specifies the individual who identified and reported the issue. It should include the name of the person responsible for the entry. This is essential for any follow-up queries or clarifications regarding the reported issue. Enter the name in a consistent format (first letter of name and surname, "nsurname").	Focal Point	Focal Point
Pharma (Y/N)	Indicates whether the issue is related to a pharmaceutical product/shipment.	Focal Point	Focal Point
Supplier	Name of the supplier involved in the issue. This is crucial for traceability and accountability in the supply chain.	Focal Point	Focal Point
Customer	The customer affected or reported the issue. This is important for follow-up and customer relationship management. Please enter only customer name, not the end destination (end destination should be part of description, if applicable)	Focal Point	Focal Point
Project	The specific project DCR is related to. This helps in understanding the context and impact of the issue. If more than one project is impacted, specify them all	Focal Point	Focal Point
Responsible party (supplier, freight forwarder, AMEX, warehouse)	Identifies who is responsible for the issue – options include Amex, Customer, Freight Forwarder, Supplier, Warehouse. This field is crucial for directing follow-up actions and accountability. Please choose from a drop-down menu.	Focal Point	Focal Point

Identify the Responsible party	Specify the name of the company identified as responsible party (e.g., warehouse name, FF name).	Focal Point	Focal Point
Category	The nature of the issue, where/what the issue was. Please choose from a drop-down menu. Options include Damaged Item, Delayed Shipment, Missing Item, Product Quality Issue, Temperature Excursion, Wrong Item, Wrong Quotation, Partner issue report, and Other in case issue can't be categorized under one of defined categories. This categorization aids in statistical analysis and trend identification.	Focal Point	Focal Point
Description of the issue (what happened)	A detailed description of what happened. This should be a clear and concise narrative that explains the issue thoroughly. Chronologically explain WHAT the issue was, NOT HOW/WHY happened.	Focal Point	Focal Point
Root cause of the issue (how/why the issue happened)	Analysis of how and why the issue occurred. This should include a detailed examination, possibly following root cause analysis techniques. Understanding the root cause is critical for implementing effective corrective actions and preventing issues in the future.	Focal Point	Focal Point
Financial impact on Amex	The estimated or actual financial costs associated with the issue. This could include direct costs like product replacement, and indirect costs for transportation/destruction of goods etc.	Focal Point	Focal Point after consultation with Direct Manager
Actions taken to address complaint/deviation (when CAPA is not needed)	Describe the immediate actions taken to resolve the issue when CAPA is not required. This might include short-term solutions or interim measures.	Focal Point	N/A
CAPA report needed(Y/N)	This field indicates whether a detailed CAPA report for the DCR is necessary. Select 'Y' for Yes or 'N' for No.	Focal Point	Focal Point after consultation with QD
CAPA plan	If a CAPA report is required, outline the CAPA plan here. This should include what corrective, and preventive actions will be taken to address the root cause and prevent recurrence. Responsibilities (who is responsible for what) should be mentioned. There are two different types of CAPA measures – both are to be described in the DCR tracker: - Preventive actions: Handling of an incident to prevent recurrence - Corrective actions: Handling of an incident to correct / limit its effects	Focal Point	QD
Closure date	Document the date when issue was considered closed (e.g. when no further actions are needed).	Focal Point	Focal Point

Table 4: Explanation of responsibilities for completing the DCR tracker and instructions on how to fill it

4.3 CAPA Report

All critical DCRs must be documented in a CAPA report and must have a CAPA plan, regardless of frequency or recurrence. For more details, please refer to attachment 2 of SOP 5.

4.4 Mock recall

To check and test the SOP, a mock recall will be performed annually as set out in the EU Guidelines on Good Distribution Practice of Medicinal Products for Human Use under Chapter 6.5. describes that a mock recall is made annually, unless there is an actual recall of pharmaceutical products occurred. To simulate a mock recall, batch tracking of a random batch is performed. The movement of the batch from each receipt of goods to each release of goods is documented and a report is created.

In the pharmaceutical sector, a mock recall is created by Responsible Pharmacist, while QD and RP are overseeing all activities. For medical devices, the Quality Specialist performs a similar role by initiating the mock recall and notifying the appropriate whole QD.

The QD is responsible for taking all further applicable steps as per activities described in point 4.1.3.

4.5 Return of goods

As stated in SMF, Amex does not accept any return of goods.

5 ANNUAL REVIEW AND TRENDING ANALYSIS PLAN

To continuously improve operational processes and strengthen risk management, AMEX will conduct quarterly and annual review and trending analysis of all DCR entries. This review will utilize data from the DCR tracker (**Attachment 1**) to identify patterns, trends, and further areas for improvement. Special attention will be given to critical or frequently occurring issues, analyzing trends to determine systemic challenges and assess potential process gaps. Findings from the Annual DCR Review will be compiled into a report (WI 11 attachment 1) and the summary will be shared as part of the Management Review with Management and with the staff, e.g. during AHM.

Trending analysis ensures that AMEX identifies recurring issues like repeated deviations, complaints and frequent recall triggers to further address systematic issues before they escalate. Moreover, the severity and frequency of deviations and complaints will be assessed, and high-risk areas will be prioritized to take immediate actions.

Findings from the trending analysis will improve internal processes, including more targeted staff training, internal audits and updated SOPs. By enhancing internal processes, AMEX will be better equipped to meet external audit requirements more efficiently as well as to align with GDP, ISO and other regulatory standards by proactively addressing compliance risks.

6 DOCUMENTATION

6.1 Revision

Amendment of this document is the responsibility of the QD.

6.2 History

IDENTIFICATION	CREATED ON	REVISED	REASON FOR REVISION
SOP 5, Version 1	22 Sept 2015	none	Initial version
SOP 5, Version 2	1 Dec 2016	Version 1	Updating of SOP
SOP 5, Version 3	30 May 2018	Version 2	General revision of entire SOP
SOP 5, Version 4	16 Nov 2021	Version 3	Updating 4.4 Simulated product recall

SOP 5, Version 5	14 Jul 2022	Version 4	Section 4.1.3 Recalls updated with contact details of AMEX person responsible for recalls, email address of the Austrian Authority that needs to be contacted in case of recalls added Section 4.2 DCR Tracker and CAPA Overview updated with one additional field of the DCR tracker – Closure date
SOP 5, Version 6	01 Jul 2023	Version 5	Section 4.1.3 Recalls – updated with new address for recalls; Section 4.4 updated to add mock up recall of pharmaceuticals
SOP 5, Version 7	09 Feb 2023	Version 6	Pharmacovigilance section updated. DCR tracker information updated.
SOP 5, Version 8	23 Jul 2024	Version 7	Austrian RA recall contact point updated
SOP 5, Version 9	01 Oct 2024	Version 8	Section 3 Responsibilities updated to reflect involvement of the entire Quality department and Responsible Pharmacist Section 4.1.3. updated to add details on alert. Same section update with the contact details of a person responsible for recalls.
SOP 5, Version 10	29 Jan 2025	Version 9	General revision of entire SOP
SOP 5, Version 11	01 Sep 2025	Version 10	Section 4.2 updated with timelines for closing DCRs depending on criticality Section 4.5 updated with a statement of no acceptance of return goods
SOP 5, Version 12	18 May 2025	Version 11	General SOP update: SOP renamed to Deviations, Complaints, Recalls and CAPA Management All details concerning Adverse events management removed from SOP 5 and included in the newly created PV SOP All details concerning Risk analysis removed from SOP 5 and included in SOP 10 All details concerning handling recalls in Kenya removed from SOP 5 and added in the WI 16 – This WI was added under 'related documents' section of the document Attachments 1 and 2 updated in line with the SOP 5 updates Defined responsibilities of Responsible Person Added definition of Safety notice and Partner Issue Report in the table 1 Criteria for DCR criticality updated